

Chapter 156-6

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The next day, the sun came out. The heavy snow melted, and the temperature dropped sharply.

Both of them took out their thickest padded jackets from the wardrobe. Afraid that Xu Qingzhu would catch a cold, Liang Shi even dug out the scarf she'd kept at the bottom of her trunk.

Liang Shi drove Xu Qingzhu to the company first, then drove to the set.

Gu Yixue didn't say anything. Apart from Sun Chengcheng, who had quite a few complaints about her absence, no one else had any reaction.

After all, she hadn't delayed the crew's work.

Even if Sun Chengcheng had complaints about her, she didn't dare make a scene.

At most, she would make a few passive-aggressive insinuations. Liang Shi just gave her a contemptuous glance, and she backed off.

After Sun Chengcheng backed off, Liang Shi sat there and started wondering: when did she change?

Before, when she heard Sun Chengcheng's passive-aggressive mockery, she would usually feel a bit embarrassed. Shame and self-blame would occupy most of her emotions.

She wouldn't have been like now—confident and bold, almost unrestrained.

It didn't start from when she died once.

At that time, she had just arrived in this world and was living cautiously, treading on thin ice. She wasn't like this.

When there were no scenes to film, she sat in the sunlight of the early-melting winter snow and began to recall carefully.

It seemed to have started from when Xu Qingzhu said she liked her.

Because she knew someone would like her unconditionally and would become her support, she slowly gained confidence.

It was Xu Qingzhu's love that propped up this confidence of hers.

Because Xu Qingzhu said: "Liang Shi, you're the best."

She said: "Liang Shi, I like you so much."

She would also say: "Teacher Liang, you really don't know how wonderful you are."

Liang Shi could feel her love at every moment, so she gained armor.

She was no longer the Liang Shi of the past who lived without edges. Even her gentleness had grown sharp.

Thinking of Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi smiled.

"What are you thinking about? Smiling so happily." Gu Yixue raised her hand to shade her eyes, then sat down beside her. She instinctively reached into her pocket to pull out a cigarette, but considering the person next to her didn't smoke, she stuffed it back in and played with a lighter in her hand instead.

Liang Shi said frankly: "Thinking about my wife, what else?"

Gu Yixue: "..."

Her matter-of-fact tone left Gu Yixue momentarily speechless.

Liang Shi asked Gu Yixue: "Are we almost done filming?"

"Almost." The lighter in Gu Yixue's hand flickered on and off. "I came to find you to discuss this. We'll push hard these next few days and finish within five days. Most of the remaining scenes are yours, so you'll have to work hard. You might have to pull several all-nighters. Can you do it?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Yes. But... why the rush?"

"Mm, I have something to do after filming." Gu Yixue said.

Liang Shi asked instinctively: "What is it?"

Gu Yixue paused, then smiled flirtatiously: "Guess?"

Her tone was light, but the expression on her face wasn't relaxed. It probably wasn't something that would make one feel at ease.

Liang Shi's ability to make connections wasn't weak either. She coughed softly and secretly leaned closer: "You're not planning to crash the wedding, are you?"

Gu Yixue's lips curved slightly. "Mm-hm."

Liang Shi: "..."

Although she knew this wasn't her place to interfere—she had heard before that in Haizhou City, the Gu and Shen families were the "two giants"—the marriage alliance between these two families really had nothing to do with a small fry like her.

But because she was fairly close to Gu Yixue, she couldn't help but say something more: "How are you going to crash it? When the time comes... it'll be very embarrassing."

From what she heard that day, Gu Yixue's status wasn't good. Although Liang Shi didn't mind her friends' moral boundaries, she felt Gu Yixue would be scorned for this.

Being an illegitimate daughter and wanting to steal her sister's arranged marriage partner—that already sounded fantastical enough.

Anyone who saw it would curse it as wishful thinking.

And it looked like Gu Yixue wouldn't succeed.

Because Shen Fenghe wasn't the type to give up her career for romance. In some ways, she was a bit like Lu Jiayi.

And that Gu Chunmian was obviously timid and cowardly.

She would bet that Gu Chunmian would one hundred percent compromise for the inheritance rights and attend the wedding.

So when the time came, they would all be paired up, and only Gu Yixue would be left alone. How embarrassing would that be?

But hearing this, Gu Yixue just laughed lightly. "Embarrassment doesn't matter."

She had always done things her own way, fearless of gossip.

Liang Shi stared at her. After a moment, all she could say was: "I wish you success."

"What if I don't succeed?" Gu Yixue asked in return.

Liang Shi paused. "Then I wish you would stop loving her."

Someone like Shen Fenghe would be very difficult for Gu Yixue to grasp.

Liang Shi shared her theory with Gu Yixue. Gu Yixue laughed so hard she clutched her stomach, laughing until tears fell. She looked at Liang Shi and patted her shoulder: "Little sister, how strong is your filter for me?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"But you are emotional." Liang Shi said: "Someone who can consistently create that kind of work isn't a match for that kind of career-focused person."

Gu Yixue fell silent.

After a long while, Gu Yixue looked at her: "Have you experienced this before?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi awkwardly turned her face away. "No."

Gu Yixue still couldn't hold back and lit a cigarette. Her face was shrouded in blue-gray smoke.

"I don't know either." Gu Yixue said in a low voice. "But I have to try."

If she didn't try, she would become someone else's forever.

Since becoming an adult, Gu Yixue had always been walking a tightrope.

Because her mother had been constantly criticized for interfering in someone else's marriage, and having grown up as the Gu family's illegitimate daughter, Gu Yixue's only bottom line in life was—don't destroy anyone else's marriage.

She didn't know how far she could go for Shen Fenghe.

But at least for now, she felt she still had to keep that last shred of principle.

She wouldn't interfere in a marriage, because that was a contract they had signed. No matter how unhappy that marriage was, no matter how terrible Shen Fenghe's partner was.

But during the dating stage, it was every woman for herself.

Perhaps a long time later, Gu Yixue would give up her principles for Shen Fenghe.

She thought that someone like her—a wandering ghost—was probably never meant to have something like principles.

Gu Yixue was lost in thought.

Liang Shi's voice was very soft. "Some walls you just have to hit yourself. When the time comes, call me, and I'll come pick you up."

This was a unique way of comfort between friends.

Hearing this, Gu Yixue laughed softly. "Thanks."